St Cyril to Pulcheria and Eudoxia

I. To those who administer that divine and heavenly office of preaching, the God of all things, through the voice of the prophet Isaiah, gives these commands in such a discourse: "Go up on a high mountain, you who evangelize Zion; lift up your voice with strength, fear not." For I say that those appointed to the sacred ministry, and who proclaim the mystery of Christ, our Savior of all, ought not to have a spirit that is cast down and groveling, overcome by idleness, and constrained by fears; but rather, with their mind uplifted as if standing firm and, as it were, placed on a mountain, they should thus strive to contemplate the exceptional beauty of the doctrines of truth, and speak with boldness, even if some of those being instructed in the sacred mysteries should prove hard and intractable, like certain proud and unbridled horses, concerning whom the blessed David himself somewhere, interpellating the supreme Maker of all things, thus writes: "With bit and bridle bind their jaws, who do not draw near to you." But if it is necessary to confront even those of such a mind, how would it not be most erroneous to choose silence and not frequently instill into your pious ears the knowledge of the Sacred Scriptures, like a sweet and life-giving stream? This indeed God long ago promised us through the voice of the prophet Isaiah, saying: "And you shall draw water with joy from the wells of salvation." And we call the holy prophets, evangelists, and apostles the wells of salvation; for they pour forth the Word, which is from above and from heaven and brings salvation to the world, the Holy Spirit supplying it to them, and thus they gladden all under heaven. Come then, let us, casting our minds into the depths of their thoughts, draw from thence the discovery of truth. For just as farmers, having gathered the most fragrant flowers

from the fields in due season, then place them in baskets and carry them to their masters, who receive them very gladly and are delighted by their seasonal beauty; so we, who have undertaken the office of teaching, offer from the divinely inspired Scripture, as from a field, not the quickly fading beauty of flowers, but rather words and a mystical instruction through the Holy Spirit, possessing the unfading beauty of piety towards Christ, and richly diffusing the fragrance of His mystery. For it is written: "For we are the aroma of Christ to God."

II. Here then, most pious queens, I present to you this discourse, which I have composed concerning the right and blameless faith, such as yours ought to be in our Lord Jesus Christ. For it is especially fitting for you, who are so holy and beloved of God, to crown yourselves with the garland of love for Christ, along with the supreme glories of your kingdom. Indeed, this is already fitted to your renowned heads, and the Lord of all adorns you with everlasting glories. Therefore, to further illuminate you, having in mind the precise and unadulterated knowledge of the mystery concerning Christ, I have composed this short treatise, demonstrating throughout every thought that, just as there is one God the Father, from whom are all things, so also there is one Lord Jesus Christ, through whom are all things; and certainly there is one Holy Spirit, in whom are all things. And as for those who divide the one Christ, both Son and Lord, into two sons, we, having learned to think rightly, will by no means tolerate them. For we do not say that the Son who was begotten from the substance of God the Father before all ages is one, and that another, who was born of a woman in the last times and made subject to the law, is different; but that He is one and the same, both before that true union and conjunction of the Word with human flesh, and after it. For the Son, who naturally

proceeds from God the Father, having taken to Himself a body with a soul and a perfect mind, was born carnally through the holy Virgin and Mother of God, Mary, and was in no way changed into flesh (God forbid!), but rather assumed it, and did not neglect to be God; for even in this way He remained Lord of all.

III. And these things indeed we have been taught to believe. For the wise admonitions of the holy Fathers and their decrees instruct us to observe with great zeal and diligence what is most consonant with the divine Scriptures, and, applying a subtle understanding to those things which are expounded concerning Christ, to contemplate the truth of divine doctrines: "Casting down imaginations, and every high thing that exalts itself against the knowledge of God, and bringing every thought into captivity to the obedience of Him." For since it is firmly established and confessed by all that the Word, who naturally proceeds from God the Father, existing in the form and equality of the same God, "did not consider it robbery to be equal with God, but emptied Himself, taking the form of a servant, being made in the likeness of men, and being found in appearance as a man, He humbled Himself, becoming obedient unto death, even the death of the cross"—it is in every way necessary for him whose purpose it is to rightly discern the power of what is written concerning Him, to have his mind full of devout thought; so that He may be recognized as both God and man at the same time, and that He may continue to be God without any alteration or change (for the nature of the Word is immutable), and that He may not reject the humility of His self-emptying. For He who voluntarily underwent humiliation for our sake in a dispensational manner, does not in any way blush at His own counsels. It is therefore necessary that He be seen as resplendent in the dignities of divinity, and yet not entirely alienated from the lowliness of our condition, on account of His

humanity; for the reason of the dispensation demands this. For if God the Word became flesh, that is, man, according to that saying, "I will pour out of My Spirit upon all flesh," let no one be disturbed if anything human is said of Him by the divinely inspired Scripture. Rather, let one contemplate His surpassing and supreme glory and majesty from His divine and supreme power and excellence.

IV. Therefore, those things which seem most likely to disturb the minds of the simpler, I shall endeavor to explain with the greatest possible clarity and as well as I can, providing an adequate solution for each statement for clarification, God again guiding our path in this course. For He "gives the word with great power to those who evangelize," as the divine Psalmist sings. Now, in that commentary which we composed for the holy virgins, we made abundant use of those statements that were more obvious and easier to understand; but in the present work, we have focused on the explanation of the more obscure ones. For it was necessary, it was necessary that your God-loving majesty should know these things and not be ignorant of those, so that through both, a perfect knowledge, like a light, might dwell in your most holy minds. My purpose, however, in interpreting each point, is to be as brief as possible. But the discourse concerning the self-emptying of the Word will be placed first among others. Nevertheless, it must be known that when Jesus Christ is named for us, we are to understand the Word of God the Father as incarnate and made flesh.

V. "For I want you to know that the head of every man is Christ, the head of a woman is her husband, and the head of Christ is God." "The first man (that is, Adam) was of the earth, earthy; the second (that is, Christ) is from heaven, heavenly. Therefore, just as we have borne the image of the earthy, let us also bear the image of the

heavenly, as it is written." The first head of our race, that is, the beginning, was Adam, who was of the earth and earthy. But since Christ has been named the second Adam, He is constituted the head, that is, the principle, of those who are reformed through Him to incorruption by sanctification in the Spirit according to His image. Therefore, He Himself is our principle, that is, our head, inasmuch as He appeared as man. Yet He Himself also has a head, as He is God by nature, namely, the heavenly Father; for the Word, being God, was naturally begotten of Him. And that "head" signifies "beginning" is confirmed for those whose minds waver by the fact that the man is said to be the head of the woman; for she was taken from him. Therefore, there is one Christ, both Son and Lord, who, as God by nature, has the Father who is in heaven as His head, but became our head because of His kinship according to the flesh.

VI. "For you know the grace of our Lord Jesus Christ, that though He was rich, yet for your sakes He became poor, that you through His poverty might become rich." Observe here very clearly both the pre-eminence of the divine and incorruptible nature, and the agreement of both into unity, in that the Only-Begotten voluntarily humbled Himself for this purpose. For no discourse can interpret the riches of divinity; but humanity is very poor, to which all things, whatever good it possesses, are God-given and from above, and above all, its very being; for it was called into existence by God, when it once was not. But He who was rich as God, voluntarily became poor and became like us, so that human nature, being elevated in Him to the heights of divine excellence, might cast off the shame of poverty. "For God the Father raised us up together in Christ and made us sit together in the heavenly places," as it is written. But we would by no means have been elevated to these things unless He who was rich as God had taken on our poor and

needy nature as a poor man. This, however, is more fittingly said to have happened to Him who is truly rich, that is, the Word from God the Father, when He became like us. Therefore, there is one Christ and Son.

VII. "Christ has redeemed us from the curse of the law, having become a curse for us; for it is written: 'Cursed is everyone who hangs on a tree.'" The legal letter declared accursed him who was in transgression and sin. But He who knew no sin, that is, Christ, submitted to judgment, enduring an unjust sentence, and suffered what was fitting for those under a curse; so that He who was equivalent to all might, by dying for all, loose the charges of all disobedience and redeem all under heaven with His own blood. He would not, therefore, have been equivalent to all if He had been merely a man. But if He is understood as God incarnate, and having suffered in His own flesh, then the entire creation is little compared to Him, and the death of one flesh is abundantly sufficient for the redemption of all under heaven; for it was the flesh of the Word who was born of God the Father.

VIII. "But we see Jesus, who was made a little lower than the angels for the suffering of death, crowned with glory and honor, that He, by the grace of God, might taste death for everyone." The divine Paul again makes these statements concerning Christ, our Savior of all: "When He brings the firstborn into the world, He says: 'And let all the angels of God worship Him.'" And again: "Who, being the brightness of His glory and the express image of His person, and upholding all things by the word of His power, when He had by Himself purged our sins, sat down at the right hand of the Majesty on high, having become so much better than the angels as He has inherited a more excellent name than they. For to which of the

angels did He ever say: 'You are My Son, today I have begotten You'?" Therefore, when the Only-Begotten became the firstborn, and one among many brethren, then also He is said to have been made lower than the angels (for He was outside creation according to His own nature as God when He was brought into the world); and yet He inherited a more excellent name than they. For the word "angel" signifies ministry and implies a servile condition for us; "for they are sent forth to minister for those who will inherit salvation." But "Son" would denote a substantial and natural existence from the Father, for we believe that His generation truly took place. How then was He, who is worshipped by angels and is co-seated with the Father, made lower than the angels? The answer is readily available: for having assumed a body capable of dying, and having made it His own, He voluntarily suffered in it, and is crowned with the highest glories through His passion, as by it He abolished death and rendered corruption ineffectual, being indeed incorruption and life. Therefore, when He names Jesus and says that He was made lower than the angels, we understand not a man separately and individually, but the Only-Begotten Himself, economically yielding His pre-eminence to the holy angels; because He truly became man, who was inferior to their excellence. The excellence of the holy angels is that they are also without flesh and are superior to death; the Son having come into these conditions through His voluntary self-emptying. But He who was made a little lower than the angels by the measure of His humanity, being in the pre-eminence of divinity, is worshipped by them, and is enthroned in seats which they always surround, glorifying Him and calling Him Lord of powers. But the reason is clear. For He descended to the measures of humanity, and took a body naturally subject to death, and in it, as if it were His own, He willingly endured death. Moreover, on account of this death and passion, He merited the crown of supreme glory;

for He Himself, existing as life and incorruption, both abolished death through it and declared corruption to be without any power. When, therefore, He names Jesus and proclaims Him inferior to the angels, we do not conceive in our minds a mere man, set apart and by himself; but the Only-Begotten Himself, yielding superior parts to the angels on account of the order of the Incarnation. For He who is proclaimed to yield to their excellence is recognized as truly having become man. Now, the eminence of the holy angels consists in this: that they are immune from flesh and that they are superior to death; but the Son was subjected to both on account of His voluntary self-emptying. But indeed, He who is said to have been made a little lower than the angels on account of the condition of human nature, existing in the excellence of divinity, is adored by them, and sits on those thrones of majesty which they surround on all sides, exalting Him with unwearied praise and calling Him Lord of virtues.

IX. "Since therefore the children have partaken of flesh and blood, He Himself likewise shared in the same, that through death He might destroy him who has the power of death, that is, the devil, and release those who through fear of death were all their lifetime subject to bondage." By "children" in this passage, He means us, who live on earth, according to what is sung in the Psalms as from the person of God: "I said, 'You are gods, and all of you are children of the Most High.'" For as far as it concerned what was pleasing to God, and the gentleness naturally inherent in Him, we would all have been children, and no one would have fallen away from intimacy with Him. But, as David says, "we die like men, and fall like one of the princes," subjecting our own mind to the passions of the flesh. How then have we partaken of blood and flesh? For the human soul, having a nature distinct from the flesh, by its disposition towards it in union, constitutes a single rational animal,

that is, man. In this manner, therefore, the Word of God also, uniting Himself to an animated flesh (and not an inanimate one, as some suppose), and taking birth from a woman, communicated to flesh and blood just as we do. Therefore, there is one Lord Jesus Christ, since the Word of God united the human to Himself, yet remained what He was even so. But if He Himself abolished the power of death, as Life and God, it is proper that what suffered death be understood as His own; so that, having risen Himself, He might be said to have abolished corruption and to have transmitted the grace of incorruption to our entire race. "For as in Adam all die, so also in Christ all will be made alive." And again: "For since by man came death, by man also came the resurrection of the dead." But that to trample death underfoot is a thing exceeding the faculty of human nature, for this reason the Word of God, by union, that is, by communication with flesh and blood, became a man like us; yet He remained superior to death even so, for He was God in flesh.

X. "For He does not indeed take hold of angels, but He takes hold of the seed of Abraham. Therefore, He had to be made like His brothers in every respect, so that He might become a merciful and faithful high priest in things pertaining to God, to make propitiation for the sins of the people. For in that He Himself has suffered, being tempted, He is able to help those who are tempted." We assert that the Word of God took hold of the seed of Abraham. For according to the flesh, He was born of the Jews, and was assimilated to His brothers in all things; that is, having taken the form of a servant, according to the Apostle's teaching, He did not disdain to be born in the manner of other men. For this reason, He also became the Son of Man, and was made a brother to those who came from the seed of Abraham, that is, to those constituted of flesh and blood. What then was the cause of these things? No other, He says, than that He might

become a merciful and faithful high priest in things pertaining to God. For Christ showed Himself to us as a high priest exceedingly benign and merciful. For while the letter of the law condemns those bound by sins, and decrees that those who have violated God's command should be punished with the gravest penalty—"For anyone who has set aside the law of Moses dies without mercy on the testimony of two or three witnesses"—Christ justifies through faith and absolves those who have fallen from their old faults. He therefore became a merciful high priest, no longer allowing that legal severity to prevail.

XI. And faithful high priest; because He is permanent, and perpetual, and worthy of belief in what He has promised. For as the divine Paul himself says again concerning the priests under the law: "And they indeed have been made many priests, because they were hindered from continuing by death; but He, because He remains forever, has an unchangeable priesthood. Therefore He is able also to save forever those who draw near to God through Him, since He always lives to make intercession for them." Observe here, how He was made high priest not for the condemnation of those who had bound themselves with sins, but rather for the purification and propitiation of their transgressions. But what, I ask, was the manner of that temptation and also of that sacrifice? For He says: "In that He Himself has suffered, being tempted, He is able to help those who are tempted." Indeed, He persevered when tempted, and patiently endured the suffering of the cross. Moreover, the Son offered Himself as an unblemished sacrifice to God and the Father; namely, that through His own flesh He might be able to bring aid to those who struggle with troubles and temptations. "For by one offering He has perfected forever those who are being sanctified." Therefore, He Himself became high priest according to His human nature,

although, as God, He is sacrificed to by all. He is the one who, according to the flesh, became the victim. He is also the same one who, according to the authority of His divinity, is propitious and merciful for our sins. Therefore, there is one Lord Jesus Christ.

XII. "You worship what you do not know; we worship what we know, for salvation is from the Jews." Perhaps someone might object here that it is by no means fitting for the supreme and divine nature of the Word to worship another. If, then, Christ is truly God, how does He number Himself among those who ought to worship? What, I ask, shall we answer to this? For if we believe that the Word of God the Father appeared in this world with His naked and sole divinity, it would be utterly unfitting for Him to worship another; rather, He is worshipped more truly than He worships anyone else. But if, having taken the form of a servant, and not disdaining the conditions of a worshipping humanity, He became the Son of Man, then indeed the adoration is fitting for the order of the dispensation and the condition of the self-emptying; but by no means for the nature of the Word considered separately by itself. For unless this is established, how can salvation be understood to be from the Jews? For it is not right to say that the Word, according to what He is considered in Himself, is from the Jews; but He is from them insofar as He became a brother to those who consist of flesh and blood, and was joined to the seed of Abraham. Therefore, there is one Christ, who indeed worships as man; but as God, He is worshipped by the entire creation.

XIII. "Yet a little while I am with you, and then I go to Him who sent Me." If the nature of divinity fills all things, where, I ask, does the Word of God not exist? By what reason, then, is He sent by the Father? Or in what way does He return to Him? He is sent,

therefore, according to human nature, "to proclaim release to the captives, and recovery of sight to the blind"; for this the reason and manner of His mission demanded. But He also goes to God the Father, yet not in an entirely similar manner. For He goes, as it were, returning to heaven in a body, so that He might appear before the face of the Father on our behalf, as it is written. And if anyone takes the word "mission" to be said also of the Word Himself, let no one be troubled by it; for it is the custom of divinely inspired Scripture to sometimes use such expressions, not because it wishes to circumscribe or define that divine and heavenly nature by place (for it knows it to be incorporeal, superior to every limit and place), but because it strives to manifest to us, by such human words, those things which otherwise exceed the grasp of our mind. For the Savior Himself also promises to send the Paraclete to us, although the Holy Spirit fills all things, according to that saying: "For the Spirit of the Lord has filled the whole world."

XIV. "When you lift up the Son of Man, then you will know that I am He." Explaining the causes of the Jewish madness, by which they were carried away against Christ, blessed John writes thus: "Therefore the Jews persecuted Jesus, because He not only broke the Sabbath, but also said that God was His own Father, making Himself equal to God." Elsewhere, he introduces them impiously uttering these words: "We are not stoning you for a good work, but for blasphemy, because you, being a man, make yourself God." Therefore, they were unwilling to believe in Him for any reason, since they thought Him to be merely a pure and common man; unaware that God the Word had taken hold of the seed of Abraham, and had partaken of flesh and blood just as we do, although He had not ceased to be God on that account: for He is immutable by nature, and perpetually the same. He says therefore: "When you lift up the

Son of Man, then you will know that I am He." For although He endured the suffering of the cross according to human nature, He nevertheless rose by divine power. And because of the resurrection, He is believed to be both true God and truly the Son of God. But if we believe that He did not raise another, but that He Himself rose, then we must necessarily establish that the body which suffered death was His own by dispensation; so that by this very reason He also, though immortal by His very nature as God, may be said to have risen. For by proclaiming the death of one and the same Christ and Son, and confessing the resurrection, we are justified through faith. Therefore, one and the same and sole Christ Jesus, as man, is said to have died according to the flesh; but as God and Life, to have risen.

XV. "Then the Jews came around Him and said to Him, 'How long will You keep us in suspense? If You are the Christ, tell us plainly.' Jesus answered them, 'I told you, and you do not believe. The works that I do in My Father's name, these bear witness of Me.'" What, I ask, do those say here who foolishly divide our one Lord Jesus Christ into two sons and two Christs? Of which one did the Jews say, 'If You are the Christ, tell us plainly?' And which of them again proclaimed, 'The works that I do in My Father's name, these bear witness of Me?' Whose Father, finally, shall we establish God to be? Is it of him who takes his origin from a woman, as conceived separately and by himself, or indeed of the Only-Begotten Himself? Yet to perform divine works by one's own power is a thing that far and greatly surpasses the powers and faculty of human nature. Since, therefore, Christ performed the same works as the Father, He was certainly not a mere man, but God clothed in flesh and blood, so that He might indeed remain what He was. Affected in this manner, therefore, He will perform works equal to His own Begetter; and the

reason for this mystery, thus explained, is free from reproach among men of sound mind.

XVI. "And the Child grew and became strong in spirit, filled with wisdom; and the grace of God was upon Him." And again: "Jesus increased in wisdom and stature, and in favor with God and men." Affirming that our Lord Jesus Christ is absolutely one, and attributing to Him equally both human and divine attributes, we truly assert that the reception of bodily increase, as well as the successive consolidation and strengthening of the bodily parts, and finally, the very fact that He seemed to be filled with wisdom, truly belonged to the self-emptying; inasmuch as, along with the increase of the body, His wisdom daily manifested itself more and more outwardly through fitting, as it were, progressions. And these things, as I said, were fitting for the dispensation of the flesh and the condition of humiliation. But to possess perpetual and constant perfection, and to be wisdom itself, this befits the very nature of the Word. Therefore, both those things that pertain to His self-emptying and those things, again, that pertain to the excellence of His divine nature are His. For the reason and manner of the dispensation with the flesh acknowledges Him to be both like us and, again, superior to us. For just as He excels the condition of every creature in many ways as God, so as man He exists in a certain way as less than Himself. For to what end is the humiliation into which He willingly descended, if He does not acknowledge what are proper to human nature? Yet the nature of the Word is not recognized in these things themselves; but rather, together with His own flesh, He assumed all those things, such as to hunger and thirst, and to be wearied by a journey. When, therefore, you hear: "And the Child grew and became strong in spirit, filled with wisdom," take the mystery of the dispensation with the flesh as a defense of the cause. For that He

was God in flesh, the blessed evangelist confirms by this reason: "For," he says, "the grace of God was upon Him." For He is not said to have the grace of God as having grace from another God, but because the Child had such grace as befits God: for the Word was and is God, even having appeared in flesh, that is, as man like us. And if He is said to have grace, that is, to increase in grace with God and men, there is nothing unfitting; even if the Father Himself accepted the dispensation, and the Son Himself, appropriating the things of the flesh, for what was fitting and useful to the mystery.

XVII. "But concerning that day and hour no one knows, not even the angels of heaven, nor the Son, but the Father only." If you certainly establish Christ to be one (they object), that is, the incarnate Word of God, that is, having become man, how did He ignore the day of consummation? We respond that ignorance of divine secrets is neither shameful for a creature, nor unusual for it. For it is written: "Who has known the mind of the Lord?" If, therefore, the Son, insofar as He became man, is said to be made a little lower than the angels (for as God, He excels all creation), what wonder is it if He is reported to be ignorant of God's secrets, just like the angels; although He is the wisdom and power of God the Father? But the wisdom of God the Father cannot be ignorant of those things which lie hidden in Himself. For if the Spirit searches all things, even the deep things of God, and that Spirit is the Spirit of Christ, how would He not know what that Spirit perfectly understands? Therefore, although He is said to have known something as man, yet as God He knew all things. So even if, as man, He displayed ignorance when He inquired concerning Lazarus, "Where have you laid him?", yet immediately, when He raised him from the dead by powerful virtue, He openly declared Himself to be God. Therefore, attributing to the dispensation of the incarnation those things that are of man, let us

also preserve for the begotten Word of God those things that are fitting for Him as God. We say, therefore, that to be ignorant might perhaps be unfitting for the creation. 'For who has known the mind of the Lord?' according to what is written. And if the Son is said to have been made a little lower than the angels, inasmuch as He became man, obviously, though divinely He is beyond all creation; what wonder is it if He is said to be ignorant of the mystery in God, along with the angels, though He Himself is God's wisdom and power? How then could the Father's wisdom be ignorant of the things hidden within Himself? And if the Spirit is said to search all things, even the deep things of God, and the Spirit is the Spirit of Christ, how could He Himself be ignorant of what His Spirit knows accurately? Therefore, even if He is said to be ignorant humanly, yet He knows divinely. Indeed, when He asked, 'Where is Lazarus laid?', as if it were possible for Him not to know according to His human nature, He acted divinely by raising him from the dead. Assigning, then, the human aspects to the economy of His incarnation, let us piously preserve the divine attributes for the Word born of God, who became like us.

XVIII. 'Jesus cried out with a loud voice, saying: My God, My God, why have You forsaken Me?' Do we then say that even the Word, who is from God the Father, needed help from above? Yet how is this not utterly foolish? For He reigns over all things with God the Father, and He establishes the heavens by His own Spirit, and is called Lord of hosts, and truly is so. But did He then weaken against the plots of the Jews, and was the hand of those who crucified Him invincible to Him? Yet the prophet Isaiah says: 'If all the nations are as a drop from a bucket, and as the dust of the balance, and shall be counted as spittle; to whom then have you likened the Lord? And to what image have you compared Him?' It must be known that the

servants of the Jewish synagogue were present, having the cohort of soldiers, and the betrayer as their leader. And when they sought to seize Him, He answered, saying: 'Whom do you seek?' And they said to this: 'Jesus of Nazareth.' Then the Savior said to them: 'I am He.' And they went backward and fell to the ground. How then could He have been weak, who by His voice alone exposed the weakness of those who plotted against Him? What then does He mean by saying: 'My God, My God, why have You forsaken Me?' We say, therefore, that when our first parent Adam trampled upon the commandment given to him and disregarded the divine law, human nature was somehow forsaken by God; and for this reason, it became accursed and subject to death. But since the only-begotten Word of God came to restore that which had suffered to incorruption, and He took hold of the seed of Abraham and was made like His brothers, it was necessary that the forsaking which human nature endured in the beginning should cease, along with that ancient curse and the corruption that had been introduced. Therefore, as one of those who were forsaken, inasmuch as He Himself likewise partook of blood and flesh with us, He says, 'Why have You forsaken Me?' This was clearly a dissolving of the forsaking that had come upon us, and as it were, an entreating of the Father on His own behalf, and a calling for benevolence towards us as towards Himself and as the first; for Christ became for us the beginning and the cause of every good. So, even if anything is said to have been received by Him humanly from the Father, He procured this for our nature, being Himself full and in no way lacking anything at all, as God.

XIX. 'Let this mind be in you, which was also in Christ Jesus: who, being in the form of God, did not consider equality with God something to be grasped, but emptied Himself, taking the form of a

servant, being made in the likeness of men. And being found in appearance as a man, He humbled Himself and became obedient to the point of death, even the death of the cross. Therefore God also has highly exalted Him and given Him the name which is above every name, that at the name of Jesus every knee should bow, of those in heaven, and on earth, and under the earth, and that every tongue should confess that Jesus Christ is Lord, to the glory of God the Father.' Behold, it is clearly stated here that the God Word, who is in the form and equality of God the Father, did not consider equality with God something to be grasped; but rather, He voluntarily emptied Himself, taking the form of a servant and being made in the likeness of men. It is further added that He humbled Himself, becoming obedient to the point of death, even the death of the cross. If, then, the one and only Christ and Lord must be divided into two Christs and sons, as some suppose, and if the Word of God honored the man born of a woman with the equality of His own dignities, and joined him to Himself according to the manner of authority and the homonymy of sonship, as if he were another Son distinct from Him—who then is it that emptied himself? Or in what way was he emptied? For if, as they say, the man understood distinctly as born of a woman is said to have suffered this, how or in what way was he emptied? And how did he descend into humiliation, who was in equality with the Word of God according to the manner of worth, that is, authority, and had this union with Him? But if the emptying is said of the Word of God Himself, again understood as a distinct and separate Son, how was He emptied by honoring another, as they say, and by clothing him with His own dignities? And in what way was He humbled, who gave the height of His own glory to the one united with Him? For if they should say that by glorifying another, He Himself undergoes humiliation, that is, emptying, it seems they do not perceive any absurdity in thinking

that even one who insults is exalted. It is therefore necessary for us, and indeed a truth that almost compels us, to believe that the Fullness empties itself, and that it would take the form of a servant—not that which is by nature a servant, but that which is beyond the measures of servitude. And He is made in the likeness of men, He who was not so by nature before He became man. And that the High One is humbled, we believe that the Word of God Himself became humanly in these things, by His own will for our sake; but remained divinely in the heights of His own preeminence. For this reason, He is also said to be highly exalted, and to receive the name which is above every name, and to be worshipped by all, and to be named Lord to the glory of God the Father. For though He existed in the preeminence of the Father and in ineffable heights, yet because He lowered Himself into emptying, and is said to have been humbled, taking the form of a servant; and again ascended to His own richness, having transcended the poverty of the nature united to Him, which is clearly the human nature, for this reason He is said humanly to receive that which always and inalienably inheres in Him, that is, to be God and Lord of all. And if it is glorious for the Father to have His own Son as Lord of all, how is it not true to say that for Him, even after taking the form of a servant, freedom and the surpassing dignity of lordship and authority over all things were preserved?

XX. 'Giving thanks to the Father who has qualified us to be partakers of the inheritance of the saints in the light. He has delivered us from the power of darkness and conveyed us into the kingdom of the Son of His love, in whom we have redemption through His blood, the forgiveness of sins. He is the image of the invisible God, the firstborn over all creation. For by Him all things were created that are in heaven and that are on earth, visible and

invisible, whether thrones or dominions or principalities or powers. All things were created through Him and for Him. And He is before all things, and in Him all things consist. And He is the head of the body, the church, who is the beginning, the firstborn from the dead, that in all things He may have the preeminence. For it pleased the Father that in Him all the fullness should dwell, and by Him to reconcile all things to Himself, by Him, whether things on earth or things in heaven, having made peace through the blood of His cross.' Here it is taught that the Son, naturally begotten of the invisible God, that is, the God Word, is the image of the invisible God; and moreover, that all things, both visible and invisible, in heaven and on earth, were brought into being through Him; and that He is before all things ('For in the beginning was the Word'), and He is the creator of the ages, having an existence older than all time. But it says that He, who is thus by His own nature, was given by the Father as head of the body of the Church, and that He Himself is the firstborn from the dead. How then, being eternally God the Word, in whom all things consist, is He said to become the firstborn of the dead, and the firstfruits of those who have fallen asleep, unless the body taken by Him was truly His own, by whose suffering of death He Himself would be understood to have suffered? For it is not without plausible reason that this happened; for He suffered in His own body. Thus He is understood to be the firstborn from the dead, though by nature He is immortal and Himself is life. Therefore, when He was given as head of the body of the Church, having lowered Himself into emptying, then He is also said to have died humanly for us, He who as God knew not death.

XXI. When the blessed Paul says that 'all the fullness dwelt in Him,' some might perhaps say: 'Behold, he knows another Christ, distinctly the man born of a woman, in whom, as another Christ

distinct from Him, and distinctly the Word, or rather the Spirit, the fullness of the Godhead dwelt bodily.' To such things we say that the Spirit-bearer knows not two Christs, but proclaims one, just as he proclaims one Father. 'For to us,' he says, 'there is one God, the Father, from whom are all things, and we in Him; and one Lord Jesus Christ, through whom are all things, and we through Him.' But come, let us examine the force of the words spoken, putting them to the test. He proclaims the image of the invisible God, the pre-eternal Son, through whom and in whom are all things, the coherence of all things, to have been given as head to the Church, and moreover, that He became the firstborn from the dead. Since He is immortal by nature, it is in every way necessary to say that the Word from God the Father was united to our humanity in an economic and true union, and thus one Christ was revealed to us, being at once God and man. In whom, then, did all the fullness of the Godhead dwell bodily? To suppose that this happened distinctly and solely in the nature of the Word is utterly foolish; for it would be tantamount to saying that the Only-begotten dwelt in Himself. But believing that the Word became flesh, not by any change or alteration, but rather that He tabernacled among us, and made His own temple the body truly united to Him, having a rational soul, we piously and rightly affirm that when the divine Paul writes that all the fullness of the Godhead dwelt in Him, he means to signify to us the indwelling, or rather the true union, in the holy flesh of the Word, not by participation, or by relation, or as a gift of grace, but bodily, that is, essentially; just as if one were to say that a man's spirit dwells in him, it is not other than himself. For in a single person, a double aspect of speech is often introduced to us, and in no way does it harm the truth. For example, if the divinely inspired Scripture says concerning God: 'Who forms the spirit of man within him'; yet how is it not clear to all that one would not understand another spirit

being formed within the man, distinct from his own spirit? And the blessed David also says somewhere: 'In the night I meditated with my heart, and my spirit was troubled.' Who, then, I ask, was meditating with his heart and had his own spirit troubled? It is necessary, therefore, not to scrutinize the figures of speech too anxiously, but rather to look to the very natures of things, and guided by them, to proceed to the truth itself. 'Therefore, as through one man's offense judgment came to all men, resulting in condemnation, even so through one Man's righteous act the free gift came to all men, resulting in justification of life. For as by one man's disobedience many were made sinners, so also by one Man's obedience many will be made righteous.' Since human nature was condemned by a curse and the sentence of death due to the disobedience of the first-formed man, it was necessary for it to rise again to its original blameless state by demonstrating perfect obedience. But this was already far beyond the measures of humanity; for no one is pure from sins. For when it had once suffered transgression, and was overcome by its inherent weaknesses, and was diseased in its own flesh with the generation of wickedness, and was in travail with the raging law of sin, how could it completely escape? 'For the mind of the flesh is utterly hostile to God,' he says, 'for it is not subject to the law of God, nor indeed can be.' The Father, therefore, recapitulating all things in Christ, and with exceeding great gentleness working out for human nature its return, that is, its restoration to what it once was, 'sent forth His Son, born of a woman,' so that, taking a body like ours and making it His own, He who knew no sin might be found on earth as a man; and thus, having become perfectly obedient to God the Father, He might justify human nature in Himself and deliver it from the bonds of death, being crowned by God the Father with the leaves of sinlessness. For it is absurd that we should become heirs of the

judgment of the first Adam, who introduced corruption through disobedience, but not partake of the righteousness of the second, who brought us back to life through perfect obedience. Therefore, when the sacred Scripture says that many were justified through the obedience of one, we do not say that simply one man of our kind was taken for this, but rather the Only-begotten who became incarnate and was obedient to the Father for our sake. 'For He committed no sin, nor was deceit found in His mouth,' as it is written.

XXIII. 'For I say that Jesus Christ has become a servant to the circumcision for the truth of God, to confirm the promises made to the fathers, and that the Gentiles might glorify God for His mercy.' The divine Paul said that the promises given to the fathers belonged to the Jews. And the blessed prophets had also cried out beforehand concerning Christ, that He would be the expectation of the Gentiles. Therefore, our Lord Jesus Christ, assenting to the Father's will, became a minister to the circumcision, that is, to the Jews, for the confirmation of the promises made to the Fathers; for it was said, 'The righteous shall live by faith.' To the Gentiles, however, He became a spiritual and life-giving blessing, so that they too, having received mercy through faith, might glorify God. For the divine Paul proclaims that the promises made to the Fathers pertain to the Jews. But the prophets had long before predicted that Christ would be the expectation of the Gentiles. Thus, our Lord Jesus Christ, conforming Himself to the Father's will, became a minister of the circumcision, that is, of the Jews, for the corroboration of the promises made to the Fathers. For it had been said: 'The righteous shall live by faith.' To the Gentiles, however, He became a life-giving and spiritual blessing, so that they too, called by faith and having obtained mercy, might glorify God. Yet, although He became a minister according to

His human nature, nevertheless, He is proclaimed as God both to those of the circumcision and to those of the Gentiles. For both have been called to life, not as believing in Christ as merely one of us, a man of our lot, but as believing in God; nor do they profess the Word of God to exist outside of flesh, that is, human nature, but they worship Him as incarnate and truly made man.

XXIV. 'For the word of faith which we preach,' the blessed Paul clearly states, saying: 'That if you confess with your mouth the Lord Jesus, and believe in your heart that God raised Him from the dead, you will be saved.' Now, since God is by nature immortal, if we do not admit the doctrine of the incarnation, and deny that He made a body capable of dying His own, how can we rightly say that He rose from the dead? Therefore, in the human body which He had assumed, He endured death; but by divine power, existing as life and incorruption, He rose from the dead.

XXV. 'For the weapons of our warfare are not carnal, but mighty through God for the pulling down of strongholds, casting down arguments and every high thing that exalts itself against the knowledge of God, bringing every thought into captivity to the obedience of Christ.' The war which the saints wage is not coarse or corporeal, but rather subtle and spiritual. For they are accustomed to be commended and celebrated, not because they wield carnal weapons, or skillfully use the points of spears or the hurling of darts, but rather because, equipped with the weapons of truth, they spiritually and courageously oppose those who wish to corrupt the rectitude of divine dogmas and rashly pervert them to their own opinions. Therefore, the weapons of the saints are not carnal, but mighty in God and for God. For they demolish human reasonings that lead us into absurd notions. And they strive to remove them

from our midst, just as they would certain destructive barbarians who have resolved to contend against the king's glory. And if anyone from that company, who are accustomed to speak iniquity against God, should lift his horn on high, they strike him down, as it were, with the doctrines of right faith, turning him back to the straight path and instructing him in the words of truth. It is therefore a truly saintly and God-pleasing work and industry to always refer to the reasons of the dispensation in the flesh whatever seems to oppose the glory of Christ. For the Word, being God, and existing in the form and equality of the Father, humbled Himself to emptiness and became obedient unto death. Therefore, it is necessary to skillfully overturn every contrary thought and, as it were, lead it captive into His obedience. For if anything human is said of Him, the lowliness in humanity will in no way harm the nature of the Word, if it is believed that He became man like us; and He did not cast off His being God, but rather, while remaining God, He assumed the human, and became obedient unto death according to the flesh.

XXVI. 'Therefore, holy brethren, partakers of a heavenly calling, consider the Apostle and High Priest of our confession, Jesus, who was faithful to Him who appointed Him, as Moses also was in all His house. For this One has been counted worthy of more glory than Moses, inasmuch as He who built the house has more honor than the house. For every house is built by someone, but He who built all things is God. And Moses indeed was faithful in all His house as a servant, for a testimony of those things which were to be spoken, but Christ as a Son over His own house, whose house we are.' Jesus, that is, the incarnate Word of God, was appointed Apostle and High Priest of our confession by the Father. For then He was named Jesus by the voice of the angel. And indeed, the name and office of

priesthood and apostleship are exceedingly small if attributed to the nature of the Word, yet they are not unfittingly adapted to the measure of human nature. For as He Himself says somewhere, 'The Son did not come to be ministered to, but to minister, and to give His life as a ransom for many.' For to be ministered to by creation is most fitting for Him, as God and Lord, and as having all that is created under His feet. But to minister is human; yet, as far as it pertains to the reasons of the dispensation in the flesh, it is not unfitting for Him who entirely humbled Himself to human things. Observe now how He performs the priestly office humanly, and exists as mediator between God and men; for every priest mediates. Yet, He does not offer the sacrifice in the manner of one of our priests, servilely, as if He Himself were not also the one to whom it is offered; but He performs it for Himself, and through Himself and in Himself to God the Father. For He performs the sacred office of our confession, that is, the faith, which we are rightly accustomed to make, saying: 'We believe in one God, the Father Almighty; and in one Lord Jesus Christ, His Son; and in the Holy Spirit.' Therefore, even if He is said to perform the priestly office humanly, He Himself receives the sacrifice divinely, being at once God and man. He is called faithful because He is always able to save those who come to God through Him. Indeed, the Father Himself is also sometimes called faithful. But how great is the superiority of His ministry as man compared to that of Moses, inasmuch as He is considered God, anyone can easily understand, and not with great effort, by considering that Moses was faithful as a servant in the house, but Christ, that is, Emmanuel, presided over the whole house as Lord, indeed, was the architect and founder of the house itself, of which house we are. For there is no comparison between created things and the Creator; nor again between Him who is by nature Lord and him who is truly a servant and subject.

XXVII. 'For I have come down from heaven, not to do My own will, but the will of Him who sent Me. And this is the will of Him who sent Me, that of all He has given Me I should lose nothing, but should raise it up at the last day.' He says that He came down from heaven and was sent by God the Father, even though He fills all things; thereby, I think, demonstrating and making clear to all that the Word, being God, descended economically into humanity for our sake. Not that He ceased to be God by nature, but rather, having assumed a body united to Him and made His own, which was for a time given over to death, He would lose none of those given to Him, but would rather preserve them and raise them up at the last day. Therefore, in saying that He does the Father's will and not His own, He rebukes the madness of the Jews and indirectly strikes at them, as those who always establish their own will, disregard divine laws, and care nothing for what pleases the Lord; for in this He testifies to His own docility, and accuses their disobedience. For He also said elsewhere to them, as they were eager to persecute and had chosen to hate, and were casting an unjust judgment against Him on this account: 'You judge according to the flesh; I judge no one. And if I judge, My judgment is true; for I do not seek My own will, but the will of Him who sent Me.' Therefore, He speaks such things according to the dispensation of the flesh.

XXVIII. But come, let us now also consider that other point. Having descended from heaven as God, He says that those who believe in Him were given to Him by the Father, so that He might not lose them, but rather save them and raise them up on the last day. How then did He raise them up? Clearly, through His own resurrection from the dead. For having quickened His own temple first and foremost, and having shaken off the dominion of death through the death of His own flesh, He became a way for human nature to

resurrection, and to be able henceforth to overcome corruption. It was therefore proper to the Word of God, who descended from heaven, that through Him He became the firstborn from the dead; so that what was given to Him, being raised with Him, might no longer perish through the transgression of the first-formed man, but rather be saved through the obedience of Christ. And He says that those who receive faith in Him are given to Him, again, as He became man. For all things of the Father are His own inheritance. But since, as I said, He partook of blood and flesh, and then we believed in Him as God, for this reason the name of 'donation' is introduced; for He who was King even before the flesh, has reigned over us even with the flesh. And indeed, as if introduced into the beginning of needing to reign, when He became like us, 'The Lord,' He says, 'said to Me: You are My Son, today I have begotten You.' Therefore, He receives His own things humanly, even though He rules over all things as God.

XXIX. 'For it was fitting for Him, for whom are all things and through whom are all things, in bringing many sons to glory, to make the author of their salvation perfect through sufferings. For both He who sanctifies and those who are sanctified are all from one; for which reason He is not ashamed to call them brethren, saying: 'I will declare Your name to My brethren; in the midst of the assembly I will sing praise to You." Perhaps some of the more unlearned, who are accustomed to divide the one Lord Jesus Christ into two Christs and two Sons, think that the man born of a woman, understood separately and apart from the Word who is from God the Father, is said to be perfected through sufferings, and that he is called the author of our salvation. And that he was perfected, and given to suffering by the Word of God Himself, as if he were another person distinct from Him. For they say that it is most fitting

for Him 'for whom are all things and through whom are all things,' because the blessed evangelist says: 'All things were made through Him, and without Him nothing was made.' 'Therefore,' they say, 'it was fitting for the Word, for whom are all things and through whom are all things, who had brought many sons to glory, to perfect through sufferings the author of their salvation,' that is, a mere man, born of the Holy Virgin. But that their argument here is full of madness, I will now endeavor to demonstrate with as much clarity as possible.

XXX. First, then, the phrase 'through whom' is also applied to the Father Himself. For indeed, the blessed Paul writes: 'God is faithful, through whom you were called into the fellowship of His Son.' And again, to those called to the dignity of freedom through faith, he says: 'Therefore you are no longer a slave but a son, and if a son, then an heir through God.' Since, therefore, the divinely inspired Scripture is indifferent in its use of this expression, and accepts it even for the Father, there is no longer anything compelling us to necessarily restrict 'through whom' to the person of the Son. Since this is true, why should we not rather, for the present, setting aside His person, then following the aim of the sacred Scriptures, and preserving the appropriate meaning for the incarnate dispensation of the Only-Begotten, say that the Father perfected the Son, who became man, through sufferings? For He 'endured the cross, despising the shame,' certainly by the good pleasure of God the Father; so that He might also make us courageous, who have chosen to follow in His footsteps, obeying Him who says: 'Do not fear those who kill the body but cannot kill the soul.' For since they were to have tribulation in the world, and be persecuted by enemies, and contend for the doctrines of truth, and accomplish virtue with much sweat and toil, He does not allow them to be broken by fear, but

rather shows them to be most courageous, having Himself passed through sufferings, so that He might also persuade us not to shrink from them, saying: 'A disciple is not above his teacher, nor a servant above his master. It is enough for a disciple that he be like his teacher, and a servant like his master.' 'If they persecuted Me, they will also persecute you.'

XXXI. Therefore, the purpose for the Only-Begotten Son of God was to suffer in His own flesh for us. And what the reason for this purpose is, the divine Paul will teach, saying: 'Since then the children have partaken of flesh and blood, He Himself likewise shared in the same, that through death He might destroy him who had the power of death, that is, the devil, and release those who through fear of death were all their lifetime subject to bondage.' Therefore, since it was impossible for human nature to abolish death (for it was held captive by it, that ancient curse having brought it to this state, that it was necessarily subject to the dominion of death), it was necessary for the life-giving Word of God to assume the nature subject to death, that is, our human nature, so that death, having attacked His own flesh like some untamed beast, might cease its tyranny over us, being abolished, as it were, by God. He, therefore, is the one who is perfected humanly for our sake according to the flesh, and divinely perfects and consummates us by abolishing the power of death. For human nature lacked that integrity and incorruption which it possessed at the beginning of its origin: 'For God did not make death, nor does He delight in the destruction of the living. For He created all things that they might exist,' and the beginnings of the world look to salvation, and there is no poison of destruction in them, nor the kingdom of the underworld on earth: 'But by the envy of the devil, death entered the world.' In this way, therefore, perfecting us, He said to the heavenly Father: 'I have

glorified You on the earth. I have finished the work which You have given Me to do.' For this is the true glory of God the Father, that through His Son He abolished death. Therefore, through sufferings, perfection came to Him, and to us, the fulfillment of what was lacking. For through Christ and in Christ we have become a new creation. For incorruption was lacking to human nature, which was thus created even in the beginning. "For God did not make death, nor does He delight in the destruction of the living; for He created all things that they might exist; and the generations of the world are salutary, and there is no poison of destruction in them, nor is there a kingdom of Hades upon the earth." "But by the envy of the devil, death entered the world." Thus, having perfected us, He said to the Father and God in heaven: "I have glorified You on the earth; I have finished the work which You gave Me to do." For truly glory be to God and the Father, who abolished death through His own Offspring. Therefore, His perfection was through sufferings, but for us it was the addition of what was lacking to what had been created; for those in Christ are a new creation.

XXXII. That He says it was not a mere man, separated from the Word, who was perfected for our sake, but rather the Only-Begotten who appeared in human form, the divine Paul again confirms by adding: "For both He who sanctifies and those who are sanctified are all from one. For which cause He is not ashamed to call them brethren, saying: 'I will declare Your name to My brethren.'" It is worthwhile to consider who it is that sanctifies, and who are those who are sanctified, and how all are from one, or from whom. Therefore, the Son sanctifies, being holy by nature as God; and we are sanctified by Him through the Holy Spirit. But how are all from one? All are from one Creator and Maker, from whom we necessarily derive our mutual brotherhood. For between created and

created, insofar as they are created, there is a natural kinship. Yet the Son is uncreated by nature, and cannot enter into any brotherhood with creation as God by nature. How then are all from one, when there is He who sanctifies and those who are sanctified? Therefore, the discourse on the economy of the Incarnation is necessary for the clarification of the matters at hand. For when He became as we are, then He Himself is said to be from one with us, and has been called a brother to creatures, having acquired a human kinship with us. For this reason, He is quite rightly not ashamed to call us brethren, not having endured, as it seems to me, to be called a brother to those who were made through Him, unless He had become like them, though without ceasing to be what He was. For then, without reproach, He Himself will praise with us Him whom the Seraphim praise, and all creation worships.

XXXIII. "And confessedly great is the mystery of godliness: God was manifested in the flesh, justified in the Spirit, seen by angels, preached among the Gentiles, believed on in the world, received up in glory." If the Word, being God, is said to have become man, not indeed having abandoned His being God, but ever abiding in those good things in which He was, then truly great, and confessedly great, is the mystery of godliness. But if Christ is understood as a mere man, joined to God only by equality of dignity or authority (for some of the less learned have held such views), how was He manifested in the flesh? (And yet, how is it not clear to all that every man is in the flesh, and could not otherwise be seen by anyone?) In what manner, then, is He said to have been seen even by the holy angels? For do not angels also see us? What then is strange or paradoxical in Christ, if, being as we are and nothing else, He was seen by some of the holy angels? And how was He preached among the Gentiles? And as what kind of being is He believed on by those

in the world? For if the disciples preached Him as simply one of us men, and not rather as God incarnate, and as such He is believed on by those in the world, then we are held captive by anthropo-latry, and have worshipped creation; and to this very thing, He Himself, who is by nature and truth the God of all, has driven us; for He Himself raised up for us the choir of divine speakers. But if Christ, having risen from the dead, said to the holy apostles: "Go therefore and make disciples of all nations, baptizing them in the name of the Father and of the Son and of the Holy Spirit," and then we have believed in Him, and have been baptized, proclaiming His death and confessing His resurrection; and having been accustomed to do this, we have in no way been accused of anthropo-latry: who then can doubt that Christ is not a mere man honored by a bare connection with the Word of God, but rather one Son and Lord by a natural, according to the economy, union with human nature? For then truly great is the mystery of godliness: for the Word, being God, was manifested in the flesh, and was justified in the Spirit (for our Lord Jesus Christ committed no sin); and He was seen also by angels, who, not being ignorant of His human birth, proclaimed: "Glory to God in the highest, and on earth peace, goodwill among men." And He was preached also among the Gentiles; and that He is truly the Son of God and the Father, and having appeared in the flesh, is believed on by those in the world.

XXXIV. "And John bore witness, saying: 'I have seen the Spirit descending as a dove from heaven, and it remained upon Him. And I did not know Him; but He who sent me to baptize with water, He said to me: "Upon whom you see the Spirit descending and remaining on Him, He is the one who baptizes with the Holy Spirit." And I have seen and borne witness that this is the Son of God.'" When we speak of one Emmanuel, and do not tolerate those who

divide the one Christ into two, what then shall we say when we hear that the Holy Spirit descended from heaven upon Him and remained upon Him? Shall we suspect that the Word from God the Father needed to partake of the Holy Spirit? And yet, how truly shameful it would be to think or say such a thing! For the Spirit is His own, just as it is indeed the Spirit of God and the Father. And indeed, the blessed Paul says: "Because you are sons, God has sent forth the Spirit of His Son into your hearts, crying out, 'Abba, Father!'" It is therefore impious even to merely suspect that the Word from God the Father Himself needed the participation of the Spirit; and to inquire curiously into a matter so clear and evident is utterly foolish. How then did the Spirit descend upon Him? For He receives humanly, the economy with the flesh making His reception blameless, or rather, necessarily leading to it. For He receives not so much for Himself, but for us; so that since the Spirit had departed from those on earth, because the mind of man was diligently inclined to evil from youth, by descending upon Him, as upon a second firstfruits of the race, it might again settle and rest in us, as those who have now achieved sinlessness in Christ and possess a life freed from all cause of sin. Nevertheless, even if He receives humanly for our sake, yet behold Him giving divinely. "For upon whom," He says, "you see the Spirit descending and remaining on Him, He is the one who baptizes with the Holy Spirit." And this is a divine operation; for our Lord Jesus Christ infuses the Spirit of the Father as His own into those who are baptized. And to this, the divine Paul confirms us, writing: "Those who are in the flesh cannot please God. But you are not in the flesh but in the Spirit, if indeed the Spirit of God dwells in you. But if anyone does not have the Spirit of Christ, he is not His." So John bore witness that "This is the Son of God."

XXXV. But I would gladly ask those who divide the one Lord Jesus Christ into two sons (for the Father showed one, and the blessed evangelist says concerning one: "This is the Son of God"): Tell me then, concerning which of them is what has been said to be understood? If it is specifically and solely concerning the Only-Begotten, that is, the Word who is from the Father, how does He receive the Spirit, though He is God by nature and has the Spirit as His own? But if they say that the man born of a woman, separately and by himself, needed the participation of the Spirit, how then is He Himself the one who baptizes in the Spirit, when it belongs only to the most exalted nature to be able to declare those who approach it to have partaken of the Spirit? But if the same one both receives and gives, it is evident that this occurs according to the principles of the economy of the Incarnation, and inasmuch as He is God by nature and truly. Therefore, He receives humanly, not so much for Himself, but for human nature through Himself and in Himself first, bestowing it; but He gives divinely from His own nature, imparting it to those who are worthy to receive it. Many other passages similar to the one at hand and having the same meaning could have been adduced; but knowing that to repeat the same thing is tedious, we say that the explanation of one is sufficient for the more discerning to accurately understand similar passages. Therefore, whenever Christ is said to be sanctified, that is, to receive the Holy Spirit, it must always be understood in this manner. For it is better to embrace piety by piously drawing the meaning of the sacred Scriptures to a correct interpretation, than by impiously denying what has been rightly declared concerning the glory of Christ, to rush headlong into error.

XXXVI. "Then Jesus, full of the Holy Spirit, returned from the Jordan and was led by the Spirit into the wilderness for forty days,

being tempted by the devil. And He ate nothing in those days; and when they were ended, He was hungry." It was fitting, indeed, that for our sake He should again stand against, and as it were, wrestle with, Satan, who had long ago been victorious, He who for this reason had descended into voluntary self-emptying, so that He might show us to have partaken of His own spiritual fullness; and might show us to have become strong and healthy, since the physical and psychological effects of illnesses, introduced into human nature by the fault of the first man, have been removed through Christ. For just as through his obedience many of us were constituted sinners, even though we incurred condemnation through his disobedience, so again through the strength understood in Christ, which is clearly spiritual, we have repelled the harms from the former weaknesses; and we who fell in Adam have gained victory in Christ. Therefore, He is set against the enemy for us as man, but He conquers as God. He is tempted again, with Satan assailing Him as one of us, and confidently promising himself that the incontinence of the flesh would join him in overthrowing the one being tempted; but he departed in shame, when human nature in Christ, in a new way, showed the law of sin, which formerly raged in the members of the flesh, to be extinguished and mortified; for this law has been abolished in Christ. Moreover, having fasted sufficiently, and having preserved His flesh incorruptible by divine power without food and drink, He barely allowed it to suffer its proper experiences. For He is said to have hungered; and for what reason, I ask? So that by both means, He, being skillfully both God and man, might be recognized as one and the same, that is, divinely above us, and humanly like us. And He is said to be led by the power of the Spirit into the wilderness, where 'to be led' signifies not so much 'to be carried away,' but rather 'to pass time' or 'to remain'; just as we often say of someone, 'So-and-so conducts himself rightly,' that is, he

lives and behaves blamelessly. He therefore sojourned in the wilderness, that is, He made His abode there, not in a bodily manner; for without drink and the food necessary for bodies, He persevered in fasting there by the power of the Spirit, beyond our human nature. But observe this: for the power of the meaning is most beneficial. He was not tempted before receiving holy baptism, nor was He led by the Spirit into the wilderness, setting this as a type for us; for it is impossible for those not yet baptized to be able to bravely endure the grievous assault of tempting Satan, or to be led spiritually. But the opportune time for such glorious and admirable achievements is after holy baptism. For thus strengthened by the participation of the Holy Spirit and sealed by grace from above, for spiritual strength, we shall be invulnerable to Satan, and we shall live as in the power of the Spirit, as if occupying a desert place by being outside the tumult of the world. Therefore, for the all-powerful Word, to conquer Satan was a very small thing, but for us, it is again a very great thing to have obtained this through His incarnation, just as it is to be renewed unto incorruption. For just as through His resurrection from the dead we have become superior to corruption, so again through His victory in being tempted, we have prevailed.

XXXVII. "Having then a great high priest, who has passed through the heavens, Jesus the Son of God, let us hold fast our confession. For we do not have a high priest who cannot sympathize with our weaknesses, but one who has been tempted in every way, just as we are—yet without sin." The confession of the right faith is made by us into one God the Father Almighty, and into one Lord Jesus Christ His Son, and into one Holy Spirit. The divine Paul writes that we ought to adhere to this confession. Since it is confessedly one Son of God and the Father, namely Christ Jesus, who is able to sympathize

with our weaknesses, and has been tempted in every way, in like manner, yet without sin, who then would be our great high priest? Is it not this one, who became as we are, and suffered in the flesh for us? For then He was called our high priest, not offering a foreign or alien sacrifice, as is customary for others, but being Himself the Lamb, the most fragrant sacrifice, the spiritual burnt offering, the most vocal turtledove, the undefiled dove, the living bread, the golden censer. "For we are the aroma of Christ to God," according to what is written. But observe for me the depth of the apostolic thoughts. "We do not have," he says, "a high priest who cannot sympathize with our weaknesses, but one who has been tempted in every way, in like manner, yet without sin." For if the Word of God had not yet become man, He knew, yes, He knew even then human weakness as Creator; "For He Himself knew our frame," according to what is written. But if it is permissible to say anything human concerning Him, He had not yet been called to the actual experience of our weaknesses. But since He took on our flesh, He has been tempted in every way. And we do not say this as if He was ignorant, but that to His divine foreknowledge was added the learning through actual experience. And He became compassionate not from having been tempted in some way; for He was merciful by nature, and is so, as God. But since, in addition to being what He is, He also became as we are, these things are said concerning Him in a human manner. And He says that He passed through the heavens both bodily and divinely. "For He ascended," as the most wise Paul somewhere says, "now to appear in the presence of God for us." And He passes through in another way as well. Who, then, is that great high priest of ours? Is it not he who was truly made like us, and also suffered in the flesh for our sake? For then he assumed the title of our high priest; not, however, in the manner of other priests, offering an external sacrifice, that is, one alien to himself, but he himself was

the lamb, he himself that most fragrant victim and spiritual burnt offering, and he himself that groaning turtledove and simple dove; he himself the living bread and the golden censer. For we are the aroma of Christ to God, as is declared in the sacred Scriptures. Furthermore, diligently observe here the profundity of the apostolic statement: “For we do not have a high priest who is unable to sympathize with our weaknesses, but one who in every respect has been tempted as we are, yet without sin.” Before, he says, the Word of God was made man, he nevertheless had the infirmity of human nature exactly explored, as the Creator of all things. For he himself, as it is written, “knew our frame.” But truly, though he knew it most perfectly, he had not yet (to allow us to speak something human about him for a moment), he had not yet, I say, known our infirmities by experience; but after he put on our flesh, he experienced all things. Nor do we say that he was previously ignorant of any of these things at all, but that to the divine knowledge which he possessed, there was added also that understanding which experience brings. Therefore, the Word of God became compassionate, not because he assumed that sympathy from the temptation or experience itself (for he was already before, and is by his very nature, merciful as God), but because after he, constantly remaining what he was, also became a man like us, those things which are fitting for human nature are aptly affirmed of him. He is said, however, to have penetrated the heavens, both corporally and fittingly to God the Father, and if he became like us economically. For as the most wise Paul admonishes, “He ascended, that he might now appear in the presence of God for us.” Indeed, in another sense also he is said to have transcended the heavens, because he is certainly known to have left the glory of the blessed angels far behind him: inasmuch as, as God, he is “above all rule and authority and power and dominion, and above every name that is named, not

only in this age but also in the one to come." For as the Son, he possesses the same glory and power with his Father, even if he was made like us by dispensation.

XXXVIII. "And no one takes this honor for himself, but only when called by God, just as Aaron was. So also Christ did not glorify himself in becoming a high priest, but was appointed by him who said to him, 'You are my Son, today I have begotten you.'" He who had humbled himself into emptiness awaits the call from the Father leading to the most customary and fitting function of the priesthood; fitting, however, not to his own nature, but to ours, that is, human nature; which, since he became equal to it, he received what was fitting for it, suffering no detriment whatsoever according to his own nature, but skillfully and appropriately using the dispensation according to the flesh. For just as he remained what he was, that is, Lord by nature, even if he had assumed the form of a servant: so, however many countless ones he had in heaven who offered him hymns and praises, that is, spiritual and bloodless sacrifices, he nevertheless did not disdain the human priesthood, everywhere preserving intact what was fitting and appropriate for human nature. He was called, therefore, just as Aaron was, yet in a dissimilar manner. For the latter was anointed as a servant for ministry; but the former, assumed according to the order of Melchizedek, ministers to the Father as a Son. Furthermore, the divine Paul, writing about Christ our Savior of all, explains the manner of the priestly ministry in this way: "who has become a priest, not on the basis of a legal requirement concerning bodily descent, but by the power of an indestructible life." Therefore, the manner of that priesthood is incomparably superior to the Aaronic rite. For the former, as I just said, was a servant, though called to the priesthood; but the latter, even in that state, was the Son of God and the Father, as God and

Word by nature according to his pre-eternal generation, and as man like us according to his most recent and incarnate generation, of which the word “today” is indicative, for it signifies to us the present time. Therefore, the Father also judges his birth in the flesh to pertain to himself, inasmuch as he acknowledges him as his Son according to his divine nature from himself, and according to his human nature from a woman.

XXXIX. “In the days of his flesh, Jesus offered up prayers and supplications, with loud cries and tears, to him who was able to save him from death, and he was heard because of his reverence. Although he was a son, he learned obedience through what he suffered. And being made perfect, he became the source of eternal salvation to all who obey him, being designated by God a high priest after the order of Melchizedek.” The most wise Paul writes and says to those who had been justified by faith: “Be imitators of me, as I am of Christ.” And indeed, the divine Peter also says: “For what credit is it if, when you sin and are beaten for it, you endure? But if when you do good and suffer for it you endure, this is a gracious thing in the sight of God. For to this you have been called, because Christ also suffered for you, leaving you an example, so that you might follow in his steps.” The purpose, therefore, for the Only-Begotten, who bore our likeness, was to suffer according to human nature, and to teach his intimates how they ought to meet the assaults of temptations, and what kind of people those ought to be who suffer persecutions for the sake of divine piety, or who are afflicted with any dangers of soul and body; and in addition to this, to set before their eyes the glorious end of obedience, so that we also may be found strenuous and prudent imitators of what he accomplished by dispensation, and by diligently following in his footsteps, may truly live a life approved by God. Therefore, through

what he himself, as man, did and endured for our sake, he wished to show that those who are destined to suffer anything adverse for the sake of his love ought to maintain a firm and unshaken mind, and to consider dangers undertaken for the sake of religion as life itself. Yet he does not permit those endowed with manly strength to rashly cast away their souls, or by negligently omitting what needs to be done, and the means by which salvation can be obtained, to expect only against hope what those who act maliciously desire, but rather by exhorting them to diligently apply themselves to prayers and to supplicate God without ceasing, he teaches these things, while in the days of his flesh he offered prayers and supplications to him who could save him from death.

XL. Furthermore, consider how this matter is full of holy and becoming moderation. For to boldly confront temptations is a sign of fortitude, yet it seems not entirely devoid of a certain suspicion of pride; but to fear, and to seem to shrink back in apprehension, and to pour out prayers to him who can save, this is an act of piety. Otherwise, why did he himself command his holy disciples: “When they persecute you in one town, flee to the next”? And how did the most wise Paul, though explicitly telling us: “Who shall separate us from the love of Christ? Shall tribulation, or distress, or persecution, or famine, or nakedness, or danger, or sword?”, flee the governor of the Damascenes, allowing himself to be let down through a window in the wall? Therefore, it was necessary that Christ himself should appear to us as a leader and teacher for every good work. For he approached God with strong crying and supplication as a man, by whom also, as a true and natural Son who could not suffer rejection, he was heard. “For I knew,” he said, “that you always hear me.” For in order that he might also make our prayers acceptable to God, he himself again initiated the matter, as it were, opening and widening

the Father's ear to human nature, and making it most ready for the prayers of those who would someday be in danger for his sake. Therefore, we were in him, as in a second first-fruit of the human race, we who prayed with strong crying and not without tears, earnestly imploring that the dominion of death might be abolished in us, and the life once granted to our nature might be re-established.

XLI. Furthermore, that the zeal for obeying God is rewarded with a splendid recompense and obtains a glorious outcome, this again can be learned from him. "From what he suffered," he says, "he learned obedience." Which is as if he were to say: "He humbled himself by becoming obedient to the point of death, even death on a cross." Yet he did not remain in that abjection and humility: for "he was highly exalted, having received the name that is above every name." The figure of this saying is indeed human: but a splendid example is here set before us; for obedience is shown to be both glorious and admirable and the conciliator of all good things for us. Therefore, that Emmanuel, not before the incarnation, but in the days of his flesh (when indeed, without any blemish, and without any injury whatsoever to his divine glory, it was permissible to do so; indeed, when the dispensation with the flesh allowed it: for otherwise, how could life have feared death?) being tempted and assailed, prayed with strong crying and tears: this we ought to consider as set before us as an example to imitate. For since he himself wishes us to be most courageous in dangers, and commands us to despise the threats of those who only kill the body: how could he have been caught suffering fear? Or how could he have lacked the strength to repel death from his own flesh, he who removes it from all, who by a single voice promised to raise those who are in the tombs, and demonstrated that he could indeed do so? For he cried out to Lazarus: "Come out!"; and to the widow's son: "Young man, I say

to you, arise!”: and immediately recalled both to life.

XLII. But if there are some who, with a certain temerity, wrongly thinking contrary to Scripture, dare to say that he who was born of the holy Virgin and offered prayers and supplications with strong crying and tears to him who could save him from death, was merely an ordinary man, they will deservedly hear one of the holy apostles saying to them: “These are the ones who cause divisions, worldly people, devoid of the Spirit.” Then, in addition to this, let them explain this: do they assert that he is merely a pure man, or rather, as they have dared to say, that he possesses equality of dignity and authority with God the Word, as being united to him? If, therefore, they say he is merely a man like us, they are certainly guilty of open anthropolatry, worshipping him. For it is written: “You shall worship the Lord your God, and him only shall you serve.” But if they respond that he was raised to equality of dignity and authority with the Word of God, and yet is not thereby prevented from approaching the Father with strong crying and tears, and supplicating him who can save; then nothing at all will prevent us from supposing that the measure of the Word himself is as great as that of him who is believed to have equality of dignity or authority with the Word. Therefore, it would also be fitting for him to fear death, to dread danger, to weep in temptations, and to be in need of another’s hand to be saved; and furthermore, to learn obedience through what he suffered, being tempted. But, I think, it would be utterly insane to think or say these things: for the Word of God is omnipotent, superior to death, and indeed too great for suffering or any human fear whatsoever to fall upon him. But though he is of such a nature, he suffered for our sake. Therefore, Christ is neither merely a pure man, nor the Word devoid of our flesh, but rather the Word united to our humanity, impassible in himself, yet suffering

human things in his own flesh. Therefore, those things which he endured as man (as I said at the beginning) are set before us as an example, so that we may follow in his footsteps. For he did this, offering himself once for all. For the law appoints men in their weakness as high priests, but the word of the oath, which came later than the law, appoints a Son, made perfect forever, by one offering, clearly that through his own body, by which “our Lord Jesus Christ has perfected for all time those who are being sanctified.” For “he offered himself for us to God the Father as a fragrant offering and sacrifice,” and perfected us spiritually through faith and sanctification, although the worship of the old law brought nothing at all to perfection. Hence, the types also ceased, and that unprofitable imperfection of the Old Testament in shadows was removed. But there succeeded, and indeed necessarily, the introduction of a better hope, through which, with Christ as mediator, who was raised to the priestly order because of his likeness to our nature, we draw near to God.

XLIII. But observe this: The divine Paul declares concerning him that “he was crucified out of weakness.” How then (you ask) does the law ordain priests subject to infirmity, but the oath promulgated after the law affirms the Son, as if no infirmity falls upon him, perfected and complete forever? For that, I think, is called perfect which is replete with every kind of good. Because he was not such as the priests of the old law, for whom it was not unusual to sometimes fall into infirmities. How then is the same one believed to be greater than infirmity, as a Son perfect in every respect, and yet again taught to be crucified out of weakness? Therefore, it is consistent to understand that he was weak, enduring the cross corporally; but as God, he was beyond weakness: “For the spirit is willing, but the flesh is weak.” But if there are some who contend

that by the name of infirmity here is meant only that the legal ministers did not live without sins; I do not object (indeed, I readily concede to those who wish to think correctly in this way). Therefore, the ministers of the law needed not one, but rather many sacrifices, inasmuch as they had to offer daily both for their own ignorances and for those of the people, precisely because they frequently fell into various infirmities, and were held by that languor which leads to manifold sin. But he, being greater than one who could sin, as God, having become our high priest, and called a priest according to human nature, offered and consecrated his own body to the Father. Therefore, according to his divine nature, he could not fall into sin, since he was not of a created nature, which does not inherently possess immutability, nor the ability to entirely avoid sin. Therefore, he is God perfect in every respect, and needs no external aid to remain firm in his holiness, since impeccability is the proper fruit of his nature.

XLIV. Now the main point of what is being said: “We have such a high priest, one who is seated at the right hand of the throne of the Majesty in heaven, a minister in the holy places, and in the true tent that the Lord set up, not man.” That old tabernacle was built by the most wise Moses in the desert, and that according to the pattern shown to him on the mountain. And indeed, it was most suitable for the priests of the Old Testament: but the dwelling suitable for Christ is that heavenly and beautiful city, that is, heaven, truly a divine and supreme tabernacle, not an invention of human art, but holy and built by God, into which He, having been brought, offers to God and the Father those who believe in Him and have obtained sanctification through the Spirit. “No one,” He says, “comes to the Father except through Me.” Such, therefore, is His ministry, of which we speak here. And although this matter is expressed in our,

that is, human words, it is nevertheless entirely divine. Is it not, I ask, something divine, to be able to sanctify believers by His own Spirit; and to offer to God, and as it were consecrate, those justified by mercy and grace, dead to the world, vivified by the Spirit, and finally conspicuous by the honesty of their life and morals? But that (even if He is said to minister) He is neither inferior to the Father, nor yields in any part to His glory, can clearly be established from this: that He obtains the throne of divine majesty, and indeed sits at the right hand of the Father Himself. For if it is true that every priest stands to offer sacrifice, and can never be understood to sit or be of equal glory with the God to whom he sacrifices: in what way does Christ not perform a new kind of priesthood, who ministers as a man, yet sits on the thrones of divinity? But if some wicked slanderer against the truth contends that a man, joined to God according to the mere equality of dignity, sits at the Father's right hand, he will certainly assert that that supreme throne, suitable only to the Holy Trinity, no longer belongs to the Holy Trinity alone. But now a fourth God, recent and made, is introduced to us, besides the consubstantial and holy Trinity.

XLV. But Christ, having come as High Priest of the good things to come, through the greater and more perfect tabernacle, not made with hands, that is, not of this creation; nor through the blood of goats and calves, but through His own blood, entered once into the holy places, having obtained eternal redemption. In what manner our Lord Jesus Christ, having entered through a greater and more perfect tabernacle, became our high priest, the words just recited make plain to us. But that the rite of that priesthood entirely surpassed the legal priesthood, and greatly excelled those things which occurred only in shadow and figure (for He Himself was that true and unblemished sacrifice), no one, I think, will deny. Observe

here, however, that our illustrious and admirable High Priest, who sits at the right hand of the throne of God's majesty in the heavens, entered the holy places only once through His own blood, and found eternal redemption. But how can He, who as God sits at the right hand of God the Father, rightly be said to have His own blood, if we are not firmly persuaded that the natural Son of God also existed as the Son of Man, and expended His own blood as a price for all, and by this means found eternal salvation for the world? For no one would say that it was fitting for Emmanuel to be sacrificed repeatedly, like some animal; since His suffering death even once was abundantly sufficient to free the whole world. But if, as some believe, He was merely a pure man, joined to God indeed according to equality of dignity or authority, but separated from Him according to hypostasis, and placed apart by Himself; then assuredly the blood shed for the redemption of the world was not that of Him who sits at the right hand of God the Father, but of some other, who rather has a relative connection with Him. For just as two princes, entirely endowed with the same authority, are not one, but truly two men; so to be equal in dignity to someone, while natures, namely persons, are distinct, does not allow them to be one, but two: and the blood of one is so his own, that it is in no way another's. Therefore, for true union, it is not enough to assert that man is joined to God by equality of authority or dignity.

XLVI. For Christ did not enter into holy places made with hands, nor into copies of the true ones, but into heaven itself, to appear now before the face of God for us. “Heaven,” says God, “is My throne”: wherefore we also say that the Son rests with the heavenly spirits, and possesses heaven as a kind of holy tabernacle, not in the manner of earthly ministers, who physically perform sacred rites and offer sacrifices with blood according to the prescription of the law for the

representation of true things. But in what way, I ask, does He now appear before the face of God for us? Did He not always exist, manifest and conspicuous, even before the incarnation? And this is easy to know, that He Himself is the creative wisdom of God and the Father, through whom all things were brought into being. And certainly, as Wisdom says: “I was that in which He delighted. And day by day I rejoiced in His presence at all times, when He rejoiced in the perfected world, and rejoiced among the sons of men.” Since, therefore, from the beginning the Father was pleased with Him, and daily took delight in Him, and He in turn brought pleasure to the Father, how is He now finally said to appear before the face of God? Indeed, the Word of God now appears in a new way, no longer without flesh and naked, as in the beginning, but in human form and nature. In this manner, therefore, He is said to appear for us, and to offer human nature (even though it had at one time been hateful and proscribed on account of Adam's transgression) in the sight of God the Father. The Word, therefore, having become man, presents us first, as it were, in Himself to the Father's eyes; so that He may commend us to the Father, cleansed from ancient sins, and renewed by the Spirit unto newness of life, and finally made worthy to be adopted as sons in the Father's sight.

XLVII. Paul, an apostle, not from men, nor through men, but through Jesus Christ, and God the Father who raised Him from the dead. To show that our Lord Jesus Christ had no need of external or adventitious glory, it was enough to indicate that He, equally with God the Father, sent ministers to proclaim Him: for those who were sent did not preach themselves, but Jesus Christ to the glory of God the Father. But since we must follow the sacred Scriptures, and are not permitted to depart even in the slightest from their decrees; come, let us briefly explain how God the Father is said to have

crowned His Son with glory. Blessed Paul writes thus in a certain place concerning the rulers of this age: “For if they had known, they would never have crucified the Lord of glory.” He knew, therefore, that He who had undergone the punishment of the cross was the Lord of glory. Now, how does the Lord of glory receive glory from the Father? The reason of the dispensation unties the knot of this question. For He receives glory as man; but He continues to be the Lord of glory as God. And indeed, the riches of His divine nature are perceived by us from those prerogatives which surpass the capacity of creation; but the condition of human poverty is made manifest to us from the fact that He is said to have received certain things: “For though He was rich, yet for your sakes He became poor.” Therefore, directing our thoughts to the rule of right faith, and striving to think what is proper concerning Him, we shall establish that He so humbled Himself to our poverty, that nevertheless we never deny Him to be rich as God.

XLVIII. The Father loves the Son, and has given all things into His hand. The Son receives as man: meanwhile, the Father excludes Himself from none of these things, but has all things in His power: for by giving them to the Son, He rules over all things together with Him. But He also subjects to Himself, through Him, the race of mortals, which is in some respects unbridled and prone to rebellion, by the scepters of divinity: since, as the wisest Paul somewhere admonishes: “God was in Christ, reconciling the world to Himself.” Here, however, we by no means assert, as some less learned individuals do, that a Christ other than He whom the Holy Virgin brought forth inhabited man and reconciled the world to Himself; but rather that God the Father Himself reconciled the world to Himself in Christ. For the Son, after assuming human nature, became a mediator and, in a certain way, a reconciler for obtaining

peace, not reconciling obedience to anyone else in the world, but as in His own person to God the Father: since, reconciled to Christ, through Him and in Him, we are also reconciled to God, the Savior of all. Hence that saying: “Come to Me, all you who labor and are burdened, and I will refresh you.” But that those who join themselves to Him are reconciled to none other than the true and natural God, He Himself makes clear with these words: “He who believes in Me, believes not in Me, but in Him who sent Me. And he who sees Me, sees Him who sent Me.” And again: “Believe in God, and believe in Me.”

XLIX. “Father, the hour has come; glorify Your Son, that Your Son also may glorify You. As You have given Him power over all flesh, that He should give eternal life to all whom You have given Him.” The Son is called Advocate and Propitiator. For He Himself renders the heavenly Father benevolent and propitious to men, and is therefore the author of all good things for us. Nevertheless, it is worthy of inquiry by what reason the Father glorifies the Son and the Son in turn glorifies the Father. He says, therefore, that the hour, that is, the time, has come, in which He Himself must plainly undergo the punishment of the cross for the life of the world. But it was fitting that the Father should glorify the Son through resurrection from the dead, and demonstrate by clear testimony that He is consubstantial with Him, and life-giving, and superior to death, and has obtained a nature alien to corruption. Indeed, the Father Himself is also glorified by this, that He has a Son similar to Himself in all things in beauty, glory, and power. And the Son clearly showed this when, having destroyed the dominion of death, He raised His own temple from the dead. Nevertheless, although He is said to have received as man the right and power over all, yet as God He absolutely ruled over all natures of things. The Father again

bestows eternal life on those who are given to the Son: but He Himself is that very life. “I am,” He says, “the resurrection and the life.” Wherefore, although He is said to have received glory and a kingdom, and power over all and everything; this, however, must be referred to the condition of the incarnation. For it is certain that the Son, as God, is both Lord of glory and endowed with the same majesty as the Father; and, as far as the nature of divinity is concerned, is in no way inferior to the Father's glory and eminence. Therefore, being thus prepared, we shall be pious, converting every thought to the obedience of Christ, and casting down all reasonings, and every high thing that exalts itself against the knowledge of God.

L. Therefore, being exalted by the right hand of God, and having received from the Father the promise of the Holy Spirit, He poured out this, which you see and hear. “For David did not ascend into heaven; but he himself says: ‘The Lord said to my Lord: Sit at My right hand, until I make Your enemies Your footstool.’” The entire mystery of the Incarnate Word can be perceived from these things. For that omnipotent right hand, and the hand that made all things, God the Word, though He was in the form and equality of the Father, is said to have been emptied on account of human nature, and exalted: not that He was raised to a glory foreign to Him, that is, to one which He did not naturally possess before, but that He returned to His own naturally inherent and inborn glory. Having therefore become man, He was exalted according to human nature, although according to nature He is always most high. And this, I believe, is the measure of nature, and what we call emptying (kenosis). Therefore, God having become man, although He was thought to be nothing other than what was seen, that is, merely a pure man, yet He was preached among the Gentiles: He was believed in the world, honored as the true Son of God the Father,

and finally adorned with the highest glory and dignity, inasmuch as He was believed to be God. Nor is this an unusual thing for Him. For we recognize true humility in human nature, and true sublimity in exaltation, even though He Himself shone with His own glory. But since all things come to human nature, and to the measure of human condition, from heaven and from God; therefore the Son, although He Himself is the right hand and the maker of all things, is rightly and deservedly said to be exalted by the right hand of the Father. Observe here again that our Lord Jesus Christ, according to His human nature, receives the Spirit, but according to His divine nature, He fulfills the Father's promises by this very act, that He sends the Holy Spirit to the faithful, not as something alien from Himself, but as His own. For God, through one of the holy prophets, says somewhere: “I will pour out My Spirit upon all flesh.” But Christ the Lord fulfills this promise when He sends the Spirit as His own to those called to faith. And to be able to impart the Holy Spirit to whomever one wishes is by no means fitting for a man, but only for the true and natural God. Therefore, when the Son imparted the Holy Spirit, He accomplished that which belongs to God and the Father. Therefore, it is something human to receive the Spirit; but it is divine and beyond man to pour out the gift of the Spirit from one's own fullness upon others. Therefore, the Word, who appeared in human form, is God, from which it follows that He is also of the same majesty as the Father.

LI. The divine Paul writes thus concerning the patriarch Abraham: “Now it was not written for his sake alone, that it was imputed to him for righteousness; but also for us, to whom it shall be imputed, who believe in Him who raised up Jesus our Lord from the dead: who was delivered for our offenses, and was raised again for our justification.” One Godhead, indeed, is adored in three persons, both

by us and by those spirits above. Since there is but one Godhead, it is rightly considered that every work, whatever is most fitting for it alone, proceeds from that one. For God the Father works all things through the Son in the Holy Spirit. Therefore, if the Father is said to give life, it is understood that He performs this entirely through the Son in the Holy Spirit. Again, if the Son is proclaimed to effect life in those who are destitute of life, this should not be thought to be accomplished without the cooperation of the coessential Father, for He always has Him who begot Him dwelling in Himself. "I do not speak on My own authority," He said plainly, "but the Father who dwells in Me does the works." Finally, if the Spirit operates this same thing, He operates entirely as the Spirit of life. Yet we say that God the Father and the Son who is begotten of Him are life by nature. Therefore, while the Father is said to have raised Christ from the dead, we shall not find the Son to have been inactive concerning the resurrection of His own body, for He is read to have addressed the Jews in this manner: "Destroy this temple, and in three days I will raise it up." Thus, when blessed Paul teaches, "that faith will also be credited to us for righteousness, to those who believe in Him who raised Jesus Christ from the dead," we have believed not only in God the Father, but also in our Lord Jesus Christ. Furthermore, it must also be observed, I think, at this point, that the Only-Begotten, having become man, indeed endured death according to the flesh, yet He did not revive by the power of the flesh, that is, of humanity, but by the power of the Godhead, "which gives life to the dead and calls into existence things that do not exist as though they did." Therefore, this vivification is rightly and deservedly to be referred not to the nature of the body itself, even though it belonged to the Word begotten of God, but rather to that supreme power, that is, to that nature which transcends all creation, just as in the person of God the Father, from whom the Son proceeds, equal and

consubstantial with Him in all things; and through both also proceeds the life-giving Spirit. Moreover, he adds that Christ was delivered up for our transgressions and was raised for our justification. For just as it happened that He Himself suffered death in His own flesh for our sake, so that the dominion of death might henceforth be dissolved, so again He revived for our sake, being the first to show us the return to immortality, and abolishing the charges of Adam's transgression. For we are justified through Christ, who abolishes the power of that ancient curse through perfect obedience in all respects, and liberates human nature from ancient crimes. For He committed no sin (but rather was found worthy of all praise in it), although it was condemned, as we also reminded earlier, in Adam.

LII. "Are you ignorant that all of us who have been baptized into Christ Jesus have been baptized into His death? Therefore, we have been buried with Him through baptism into death, so that just as Christ was raised from the dead through the glory of the Father, so too we may walk in newness of life." Our Lord Jesus Christ, having despoiled Hades and liberated the multitude of spirits that were held captive in the subterranean chambers, revived, having been resurrected on the third day, and, being alive again, said to His holy apostles: "Go therefore and make disciples of all nations, baptizing them in the name of the Father and of the Son and of the Holy Spirit." Since, therefore, we are baptized into the one name of the Father, and into the one name of the Son, and into His death, and into the Holy Spirit, let those who divide the one Christ and Son into two sons, and who say that man was joined to God only according to an equality of dignity or authority, teach us into whose death we have been baptized. For if they say that we have been baptized into the death of the divine Word, conceived as naked and by itself, then

we shall clearly attribute corruption to an incorruptible nature, and we shall ascribe death to Him who is life by His very nature. But if they respond that we have been washed into the death of Him who is understood to have been born properly, separately, and by Himself from the Holy Virgin, how can they not openly declare that He is indeed the one who is ranked with the Father and the Holy Spirit? Perhaps even the Word begotten of God is stripped of true sonship if He is capable of death, into whose death we have been baptized? But who, I ask, whose mind is sound, would not perceive the manifest absurdity of this doctrine? It must therefore necessarily be established that the Word of God became like us and voluntarily underwent death in the flesh. For in this way we have been baptized into His death, since there is only one Son, who indeed could suffer nothing according to the nature of His divinity, but could suffer according to His humanity. Finally, that Christ transforms us into newness of life through the resurrection, this is not in question. For He presents us to Himself and to the Father as living from the dead, as it is written: "Indeed dead to sin, but alive to righteousness."

LIII. "But if the Spirit of Him who raised Jesus Christ from the dead dwells in you, He who raised Jesus Christ from the dead will also give life to your mortal bodies through His Spirit who dwells in you." Although the only-begotten Word of God is life by nature, yet because He took on a body subject to death, by the grace of God He tasted death for everyone through His own flesh; but by divine power He returned to life, inasmuch as it was impossible for Him to be held by death. For these reasons, therefore, He is said to have been raised from the dead by the Father. Now, let us consider carefully, if you please, how the Father is said to give life to our mortal bodies through His Spirit who dwells in us. He will indeed give life, and one cannot doubt the truth of this matter; nevertheless,

that same life-giving Spirit is also the Spirit of Christ. For it is written: "You are not in the flesh but in the Spirit, if indeed the Spirit of God dwells in you. But if anyone does not have the Spirit of Christ, he does not belong to Him." And again, concerning the holy apostles, it is written: "When they had come to Mysia, they attempted to go into Bithynia, but the Spirit of Jesus did not allow them." Since, therefore, the Spirit is also proper to Him who was raised, even though God the Father is said to give us life in the Spirit, who can doubt that the resurrection occurred in human nature in such a way that God the Word, together with His own Father, from whom He naturally proceeds, accomplished it, and whose own is that life-giving Spirit?

LIV. "Do you seek proof of Christ speaking in me, who is not weak in us, but powerful in you? For though He was crucified through weakness, yet He lives by the power of God. For we also are weak in Him, but we shall live with Him by the power of God in you." Some of those who believed in our Lord Jesus Christ, having taken offense from the words uttered by certain individuals, had fallen headlong into such thoughts: "If He was truly God, and the natural Son of the omnipotent God, why did He not escape the hands of His murderers? And how, by enduring the most ignominious death on the cross, can He not be understood to have been weakened like us, and to have been overcome by the hands of those who crucified Him?" To such thoughts, the divine Paul thus responds: "If you wish to truly test who and what kind of one speaks in me, diligently considering those things that pertain to us, you will find a sufficient solution to this knotty problem. For He was not weak in us, but rather showed Himself most powerful through His own Spirit, so that it is possible to easily overcome any assaults of temptations and bravely resist all attacks of afflictions." What then, someone might

say, O Paul, do you assert that enduring the cross was not an act of weakness, but rather a demonstration of power? Indeed, of divine power? "By no means," he says. "For I confess that He was weakened in the flesh, but again revived by the power of God; for He was God by nature." Why then, or how, was He weakened? By allowing His own body to taste death for our sake, "so that through death He might destroy him who had the power of death, that is, the devil, and deliver those who through fear of death were subject to slavery all their lives." Since, therefore, this brief weakness, I mean according to the flesh, was the cause of salvation for those throughout the whole world, how was it not altogether fitting that He should undergo that weakness, so that through it He might destroy death? Again, having given life to His own temple, He is admired for accomplishing this not by carnal weakness, but by divine power: "For He Himself is the power of the Father, the resurrection and the life." Therefore, He lives always, for He is life. And that we too shall live with Him, having been weakened with Him, at least in dying for a time, even if we are in hopes of eternal life, how can one doubt? For He revived from the dead, having become the way to life for our nature. For He is called "the firstborn from the dead," and "the firstfruits of those who have fallen asleep."

LV. "Now my soul is troubled. And what shall I say? Father, save me from this hour. But for this purpose I came to this hour." "Father, glorify Your Son." And again elsewhere: "And He began to be sorrowful and distressed, and said: 'My soul is exceedingly sorrowful, even to death.'" And again: "And Jesus, crying out with a loud voice, said: 'Father, into Your hands I commit My spirit.'" Those who are overcome by the opinion of Apollinaris and have chosen to believe what he thought, resisting and saying that the temple united to the Word was soulless and mindless, what, I ask,

can they say when they read that the holy evangelists have recorded such things about Christ, the Savior of us all? For, by all likelihood, that supreme and divine nature of the Word would be utterly incapable of fear, or sorrow, or any causes of timidity. For it would entirely refuse to ever be in such things, and would not at all endure passions such as ours. But a body, soulless and mindless, would not admit sorrow, nor would it conceive anything gloomy, or foresee fear from things expected to happen. Such things, however, are suffered, as I think everyone agrees, by a rational soul contemplating with the mind both present things and, in addition to these, things that are to come. How then, therefore, does Emmanuel say: "Now my soul is troubled"? And how did He begin to be sorrowful and distressed? Or what spirit, in short, did He commit into the hands of God the Father, if this is utterly alien to the divinity, and not even of mere soulless flesh? It is therefore evident that the Only-Begotten became man, having taken not a soulless and mindless body, but rather one animated by a rational and perfect soul, possessing all that pertains to its nature. And just as He appropriates all things of His own body, so too He appropriates those of the soul. For it was necessary for Him to be assimilated to us in all things, whether they pertained to the soul or to the body. And we too consist of a rational soul and a body. Therefore, just as He sometimes dispensatorily permitted His own flesh to suffer what is proper to the flesh, so again He permitted His soul to suffer its own things. Finally, although He was God by nature, and superior to all creation, He always carefully observed those things that pertained to His self-emptying. Moreover, He commends His own spirit, that is, His soul united to Him, to God the Father, so that through this He might again bestow a new benefit upon us. For formerly, human souls, stripped of their bodies, were sent down to the subterranean prisons, there to fill the storehouses of death; but

after Christ committed His own spirit into the hands of the Father, He also opened this way for us. For we do not now descend to the underworld, but rather follow our Leader, and we live in good hope until Christ will finally recall all to life.

LVI. "As the living Father sent Me, and I live because of the Father, so also he who eats Me will live because of Me." I would gladly ask those who divide the one Christ into two Christs: Which one, then, is He who was sent by God the Father, and lives because of the Father, and for this reason is life-giving? For if they say that it is the Word, naked and existing by itself, how, I ask, is it eaten by us so that we may live through it? For the divine nature is utterly incorporeal. But if they assert that only a man, conceived separately and by himself, was sent, how does he have the power of giving life because he obtains life from the Father? Do not all of us who live on earth live because God the Father gives us life? Do we not "live and move and have our being in Him"? Since, therefore, we all live because of the Father, how is it that only the body of one man is proclaimed to be the one that does this, and why do not the bodies of others have the same power, if indeed all of us, as I said, exist and live because of the Father? What then shall we say to these things? The Word of God, when He appeared in human form, was an apostle, that is, one sent. For He was sent "to proclaim release to the captives and recovery of sight to the blind." And He lives because of the Father, for He was begotten of the living Father. For it was necessary, in every way and by all means, that He who proceeded from the living and life-giving God the Father should be life by nature. But since He made His own the body taken from the Holy Virgin, He made it life-giving, and that very appropriately. For it is the body of Life, which gives life to all things. Therefore, it is not permissible to divide the one Son and Christ and Lord into two sons,

since He Himself is both life, as being from the living Father who is life, and also life-giving through His own body, inasmuch as He became God-man like us.

LVII. "For just as the Father has life in Himself, so He has granted the Son also to have life in Himself; and He has given Him authority to execute judgment, because He is the Son of Man." In what way, then, would one suppose the Father to have life in Himself? Is it from outside and infused, and given by another? Yet how would it not be foolish to think or say this? For such a statement would not moderately blaspheme the ineffable nature. First, then, the God of all would no longer be simple in nature, but rather composite, if the life in Him were other than Himself. Indeed, one who gave life to another as not having it would be greater than Him, and incomparably superior in all good things, if He were to be apprehended as having received life at all. But it is, as I said, among the most utterly detestable things to suppose these matters to be so, and to imagine God the Father to have received life as if it were introduced from outside. For to teach or to think this, what else would it be but open delirium? Indeed, what but manifest blasphemy against that ineffable nature? For first, if the life He possesses were distinct from Himself, the God of all would not be a simple nature, but composite. Moreover, if it were established that He had received life from elsewhere, then he who imparted life to one not having it would undoubtedly be many times greater than Him, and more abundant in all good things. Finally, to imagine these things to be so, that is, to conceive of God the Father as obtaining life from elsewhere, and as if adventitious; this would be nothing else, as I said, than to rave most absurdly. Therefore, He has life in Himself, not as something acquired or introduced, but rather as naturally inherent in Him and as a substantial fruit. In this same manner, He

gave the Son also to have life in Himself. Then, one might ask, how could the Son, having received life, possess it substantially in Himself? He has life in Himself, then, as existing naturally from the Father, inasmuch as He is understood to be God. Yet He is said to receive it along with the power to judge, even though He is a judge as God. And what the manner of this reception might be, He Himself will teach by saying, 'because He is the Son of Man.' For it is not proper to man to be able to have life from himself. But since the body united to the living Word became proper to Him, for this reason, and indeed very fittingly, He is said to have received life, as having His life-giving energy. And He Himself again appropriates this matter, whose own body it became, the body that received life.

LVIII. Our Lord Jesus Christ Himself says somewhere: 'Nevertheless, when the Son of Man comes, will He find faith on the earth?' Come then, let us again examine the meaning of these words and consider what kind of faith our Lord Jesus Christ, returning from heaven, will seek on earth. For if He wishes to be believed by us to be not God, nor truly God, but rather a man, having nothing beyond what is ours, how could anyone doubt that He would find such a conception, that is, such faith and opinion, not among us, but rather among Greeks and Jews? For idolaters and those who worship the creation rather than the Creator, hearing of the cross which He endured for us, and moreover of His death, these wretched ones laugh in derision; and if anyone calls Him God, they immediately leap up, declaring the matter to be man-worship. And those of the circumcision rose up against the Savior, saying plainly: 'For a good work we do not stone You, but for blasphemy, because You, being a man, make Yourself God.' Therefore, it is absolutely necessary for us, who are accustomed to think rightly, to acknowledge, inclining towards the truth, that He who became the Son of Man for our sake

is God by nature; lest, by casting ourselves into the accusations of the erring, we unwittingly choose to think the same things as they, and hold meager opinions about Christ, just as they do.

LIX. Christ says somewhere: 'For the Father judges no one, but has given all judgment to the Son, that all may honor the Son, just as they honor the Father.' And again, as we were just saying: 'For just as the Father has life in Himself, so He has given to the Son also to have life in Himself and to exercise judgment, because He is the Son of Man.' And blessed David also sings somewhere: 'For God is judge.' And His disciple also wrote: 'There is one lawgiver and judge.' Therefore, the act of judging would be fitting for no other of existing beings, except for God alone, who is over all. How then did He give it to the Son of Man? If indeed as to one of us, how will He speak truly when He says: 'My glory I will not give to another'? For it is God's glory to be judge. But if, in giving it to the Son, He Himself did not cease to judge, due to the identity of substance; and the one who received it is the Son of Man; how is it not clear to all that the Word is God by His ineffable generation from God the Father, and the same is also the Son of Man because He was united to flesh and underwent birth from a woman like us? Therefore, when He says to the Jews: 'Why do you seek to kill me, a man who has spoken the truth to you?' And again: 'And no one has ascended into heaven except He who descended from heaven, the Son of Man.' And again: 'And just as Moses lifted up the serpent in the wilderness, so must the Son of Man be lifted up.' Or when He says of Himself: 'For the Son of Man is about to come in the glory of His Father with His holy angels.' And again: 'Who do men say that I, the Son of Man, am?' Or, in short, whenever 'man' is named in divinely inspired Scripture, we do not say that He is man separately and apart, dividing from Him the Word who is from God the Father;

rather, we believe that He is also true God, and became the Son of Man for us economically, while remaining God, and there is one Lord Jesus Christ. And it is utterly impious to divide Him into two sons and two Christs, after that indissoluble union, which is beyond and above all mind and reason. And it would perhaps not be too difficult for those who wish to examine all that is written about Christ to make a comparison of many more ideas; but we know what is written: 'Give opportunity to a wise man, and he will be wiser.' For the God of all will guide your most God-loving ears, O most religious empresses, through the Holy Spirit, so that you may be able to understand rightly. For Christ, finding in you such an unwavering and steadfast faith, will richly crown you with heavenly blessings and declare you most blessed. For all our hope is in Christ, through whom and with whom be glory to the Father with the Holy Spirit forever and ever. Amen.